

Psalms 116

I Love the Lord

I love the Lord, because he hath heard my voice and my supplications
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *I love the LORD, because he hath heard my voice and my supplications.*
- 2 *Because he hath inclined his ear unto me, therefore will I call upon him as long as I live.*
- 3 *The sorrows of death compassed me, and the pains of hell gat hold upon me: I found trouble and sorrow.*
- 4 *Then called I upon the name of the LORD; O LORD, I beseech thee, deliver my soul.*
- 5 *Gracious is the LORD, and righteous; yea, our God is merciful.*
- 6 *The LORD preserveth the simple: I was brought low, and he helped me.*
- 7 *Return unto thy rest, O my soul; for the LORD hath dealt bountifully with thee.*
- 8 *For thou hast delivered my soul from death, mine eyes from tears, and my feet from falling.*
- 9 *I will walk before the LORD in the land of the living.*
- 10 *I believed, therefore have I spoken: I was greatly afflicted:*
- 11 *I said in my haste, All men are liars.*
- 12 *What shall I render unto the LORD for all his benefits toward me?*
- 13 *I will take the cup of salvation, and call upon the name of the LORD.*
- 14 *I will pay my vows unto the LORD now in the presence of all his people.*
- 15 *Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of his saints.*
- 16 *O LORD, truly I am thy servant; I am thy servant, and the son of thine handmaid: thou hast loosed my bonds.*
- 17 *I will offer to thee the sacrifice of thanksgiving, and will call upon the name of the LORD.*
- 18 *I will pay my vows unto the LORD now in the presence of all his people,*
- 19 *In the courts of the LORD'S house, in the midst of thee, O Jerusalem. Praise ye the LORD.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 116 is intensely personal thanksgiving from someone who was near death—sorrows of death compassing him, pains of hell taking hold—and who was heard and delivered when he called. Henry notes the psalm's unusual candor in verse 11, admitting he once said in his haste that all men are liars, as evidence that genuine faith does not require pretending past doubt or despair never happened; it simply refuses to let that despair have the final word.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

Love for God is grounded immediately in specific experience: because He has heard my voice and supplications, I will call on Him as long as I live. The crisis is described bluntly—sorrows of death, pains of hell, trouble and sorrow—met by a simple, urgent cry: Lord, deliver my soul.

Verse 5-9

God's character is named directly—gracious, righteous, merciful—and His preservation of the simple recalled personally: brought low, and He helped. The psalmist addresses his own soul, commanding it to return to rest since the Lord has dealt bountifully, tracing that bounty to deliverance from death, tears, and falling, resolving to walk before the Lord in the land of the living.

Verse 10-14

A striking admission follows: I believed, therefore I spoke, even though greatly afflicted, and in my haste I said all men are liars—honest confession of a despairing overstatement rather than a polished testimony. The response to such mercy is not silence but active repayment: taking the cup of salvation, calling on God's name, paying vows publicly before all His people.

Verse 15-19

The preciousness of the saints' death in God's sight is affirmed, followed by renewed personal devotion: truly Your servant, whose bonds You have loosed. The psalm closes with concrete acts of gratitude—offering the sacrifice of thanksgiving, calling on the Lord's name, paying vows in the courts of His house, in the midst of Jerusalem—ending, as so many of these psalms do, with praise to the Lord.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Love for God here is not abstract sentiment but a direct response to being specifically heard and delivered in genuine crisis, and the psalm's honesty about despair along the way—including an overstated moment of doubting everyone—shows that real faith absorbs such moments rather than needing to erase them. Gratitude is expressed not merely as feeling but as concrete, public action: a cup lifted, vows paid, sacrifice offered in the actual presence of God's people.

Application for life today.

Identify a specific time God heard your voice in genuine trouble, and let verse 2's resolve—'therefore will I call upon him as long as I live'—become a concrete commitment rather than a passing feeling of gratitude. If you have ever said something as despairing as verse 11 in a hard season, let this psalm's honesty give you permission to admit it without treating it as disqualifying evidence against your faith. Turn gratitude into a specific public or communal act this week—naming it aloud to someone, not only feeling it privately.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What specific instance of God hearing your voice in real trouble (vv. 1–4) deserves to become the kind of lifelong resolve verse 2 describes, rather than a passing feeling?

2. How does the psalmist's honest admission of despairing overstatement (v. 11) give you permission to acknowledge a similarly dark moment in your own faith without treating it as disqualifying?

3. What would it look like to turn your current gratitude into a specific, public act—as verses 13–14 and 17–18 describe—rather than keeping it privately felt?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).